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Slate of new state laws take effect

Measures include gas tax freeze and changes for driving tests, tuition

By Jeremy Gorner and Dan Petrella
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

More than a dozen new laws take effect in Illinois on Wednesday, touching everything from transportation and education to prisons and liquor licenses.

Chief among them is the state's new \$55.9 billion spending plan, which covers the budget year running through June 30, 2027. While the new budget won't raise the state's sales or income tax rates, it relies on a series of new taxes and tweaks to be balanced, including a six-month pause on an inflation-based increase of a per-gallon gasoline tax that would otherwise jump by 1.3 cents, to 49.6 cents, on Wednesday.

The spending plan also shifts \$12.5 million per month for one year from the state's separate 6.25% sales tax on gasoline — money that normally funds public transit — to the state's general operating budget. The \$150 million windfall is the result of higher gas prices caused by President Donald Trump's war in Iran.

The budget covers the final six months of Democratic Gov. JB

See **LAWS** on Page A10

Mayor: Mental health teams to get police terminals back

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson said Tuesday he's working to get Chicago Police Department terminals back to the city's mental health crisis teams, which have struggled to find psychiatric emergencies they can help defuse since police took the equipment away.

Speaking at a City Hall news conference, Johnson confirmed the update following this week's Tribune story that found the Police Department took out those portable data terminals last July, leading to a major drop in responses for the Crisis Assistance Response and Engagement team that had relied heavily on the machines to learn about incidents in real time.

Johnson did not provide a deadline for the teams to again have the terminals.

"Yeah, so we're working to have those PDTs restored," Johnson told reporters. "As I said, this is a brand-new program, it's unprecedented,

See **TERMINALS** on Page A4



An expectant mother sits with her 11-year-old son on Tuesday for a portrait for the Chicago Tribune. The mother has feared the possibility her new child could be born here without the typical rights and protections of an American citizen. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Supreme Court affirms birthright citizenship

Illinois immigrants and leaders rejoice as justices reject Trump's executive order

By Laura Rodríguez Presa, Angie Leventis Lourgos and Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For months, the expectant mother in Chicago has feared the possibility her daughter could be born here without the typical rights and protections of an American citizen.

The pregnant mother of four — who is due in a few weeks — described intense anxiety as the matter of birthright citizenship loomed before the Supreme Court.

Yet the 42-year-old undocumented woman expressed relief and gratitude Tuesday when the high court affirmed the nation's long-standing practice of birthright citizenship, rejecting President Donald Trump's executive order that declared children born to parents who are in the United States illegally or temporarily are not citizens.

"It's like a weight lifted off my shoulders," said the woman, who was brought here from Mexico as a baby and asked to remain anonymous due to the tenuous nature

MORE COVERAGE: Justices upheld state laws barring transgender girls and women from playing on school athletic teams in another setback for transgender people. **Nation & World, Page B4**

of her immigration status. "I'm excited that (my baby) won't be stripped of her rights."

Many Illinois immigrants and local leaders celebrated the 6-3 Supreme Court decision preserving birthright citizenship protections, which dealt a major blow to

Trump's anti-immigration agenda.

In the case *Trump v. Barbara*, the high court confirmed that the Constitution's 14th Amendment broadly guarantees citizenship to those born on U.S. soil regardless of parental immigration status, with narrow exceptions for children of a foreign occupying force or international diplomats.

On the first day of Trump's second term, he signed an executive order ending automatic birthright citizenship, which upended

See **CITIZENS** on Page A4

Justices to hear Cook County assault weapons ban case



An employee holds a Colt Match Target 9 mm AR semiautomatic rifle at Suburban Sporting Goods in Melrose Park on Tuesday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Arguments could be precursor to sweeping ruling on gun rights

By Rebecca Johnson and Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The U.S. Supreme Court indicated Tuesday it would hear arguments possibly later this year over Cook County's ban on so-called assault weapons and a similar law in Connecticut, a precursor to what could be a sweeping ruling on the constitutional right to own such firearms.

The Cook County case stems from a lawsuit by three county residents and two gun rights organizations against county officials,

alleging the county's assault weapons ban — which includes prohibitions on the AR-15 and similar semiautomatic rifles — violates the Second and Fourteenth amendments.

Cook County State's Attorney Eileen O'Neill Burke vowed to "not back down" from defending the ordinance, saying assault weapons "have no place in our communities."

"Countless victims have endured the devastating impact of gun violence," she said in a statement after the court declared it would hear arguments in the case. "We will defend this lawful ordinance before this nation's highest court to continue protecting the

See **GUNS** on Page A6

BUSINESS

Video gambling tussle

As the battle between Bally's and the city heats up over the advent of video gambling terminals, the casino company has enlisted former Mayor Lori Lightfoot's law firm to navigate the dispute.

FOOD & HEALTH

Cafe is pretty in pink

The world's largest Hello Kitty Cafe has opened in Chicago's Loop with a speakeasy-inspired Bow Room that offers afternoon tea featuring an Italian beef croissant with mild giardiniera.

SPORTS

Young Hawks back on ice

As the Blackhawks development camp continues, prospects took to the ice to complete drills under coaches. Skaters gained reps and eased themselves into the Hawks' system.

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 97 L: 78
THU. H: 95 L: 77
FRI. H: 90 L: 73
Complete details on Page A18

INDEX

Almanac A10
Arts & Living B8
Comics B12-B13
Crossword B13
Editorials A7
Horoscope B12
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A10
Television B11

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